

DETECTIVE DALE & DETECTIVE BASWELL CASE FILE #01-MSP-CIB-04121

Case file code breakdown: year (01), MSP, Criminal Investigation Bureau, Case #04121

THE FACTS:

- Cecil County Sheriff's Office receives a call from Zion, Maryland regarding a possible forest fire in the morning hours of 4 February 2001.
- The initial call is bungled as the sheriff's office is too distracted with the recent fatal shooting of 2 individuals in the town post office. The county is not responsible for the wellness of the orphanage located in the grounds, nor the woods past its borders.
- Cecil County finally arrives at the scene in the evening of 4 February, immediately puts out call for excavation equipment and rescue personnel.
- After mistakenly believing that everyone who is supposed to be there is missing, the first body is pulled out of the wreckage in 6 February. Cecil County immediately pushes the case up a rank and hands it over to MSP. Dale and Baswell complain on length about the lack of effort assigned to the incident by Cecil County, and proceed to blame them on ruining the outcome.
- As the excavation proceeds, Dale and Baswell collect damning evidence regarding the incompetence of Cecil County. It is quickly sidelined by the overwhelming no. of discoveries.
- 6 found dead with various gunshot and blunt weapon injuries. Everything that used to be standing was lost to arson. No children are found anywhere. All but one caretaker is dead.
- Identified bodies: Ryan Innokenty, Alexi Arseni, Sabina Appolonov, John Doe (Confirmed to be a Russian illegal alien, referenced to past video evidence of an armed robbery in Baltimore).
- Unidentified bodies: John Doe, John Doe, both believed to be Russian illegal aliens likewise.
- Traces of what could be called satanic worship found on the grounds, though in the end could not be factored into the motive as it's too piecemeal compared to the very obvious gunfight.
- Abundant evidence of a shootout, a gasoline accelerated fire, remains of foreign firearms and many shell casings.
- No children found on the scene. Only one FBI case file correspondence happened with the MSP. Case declared cold in early 2002.

THE CONCLUSIONS:

- Baswell and Dale fixate on “devil worship” at Cornucopia House in the earlier stages of the investigation. Based on the bizarre fragments of documents and disturbing iconography found in the wreck of cottage and on random trees, the official narrative is that at some point, Yelena Kalamatiano converted to some sort of cult worship and began hiring staff for her orphanage based on the tenets of her beliefs. No coherent ideology can be gleaned, but it was clearly related to the ritual abuse of children. Rising cult activity led to mass hysteria among children and caretakers.
- This idea is eventually dismissed entirely for the lack of a better explanation. Nothing that was pulled out of the wreckage actually proves the activity of a satanic pedophile cult, much less disproving that it's organized crime related violence. Dale and Baswell stop making references to cult activity entirely a few weeks down the line.
- Closing words: Russian mafia internal affairs taking their due. Tying the death of the adults to gang violence and considering the absence of Yelena, the last snapshot of the investigation is that organized crime came around to take its due and left with the owner of the property. Ryan's drug priors make the argument seemingly waterproof. Yelena is still a missing person, likely dead and disposed of. Cecil County is responsible for making the case significantly more complicated than it could have been due to its slow response and awful decisionmaking.